State of the Web 2020–2025

Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale

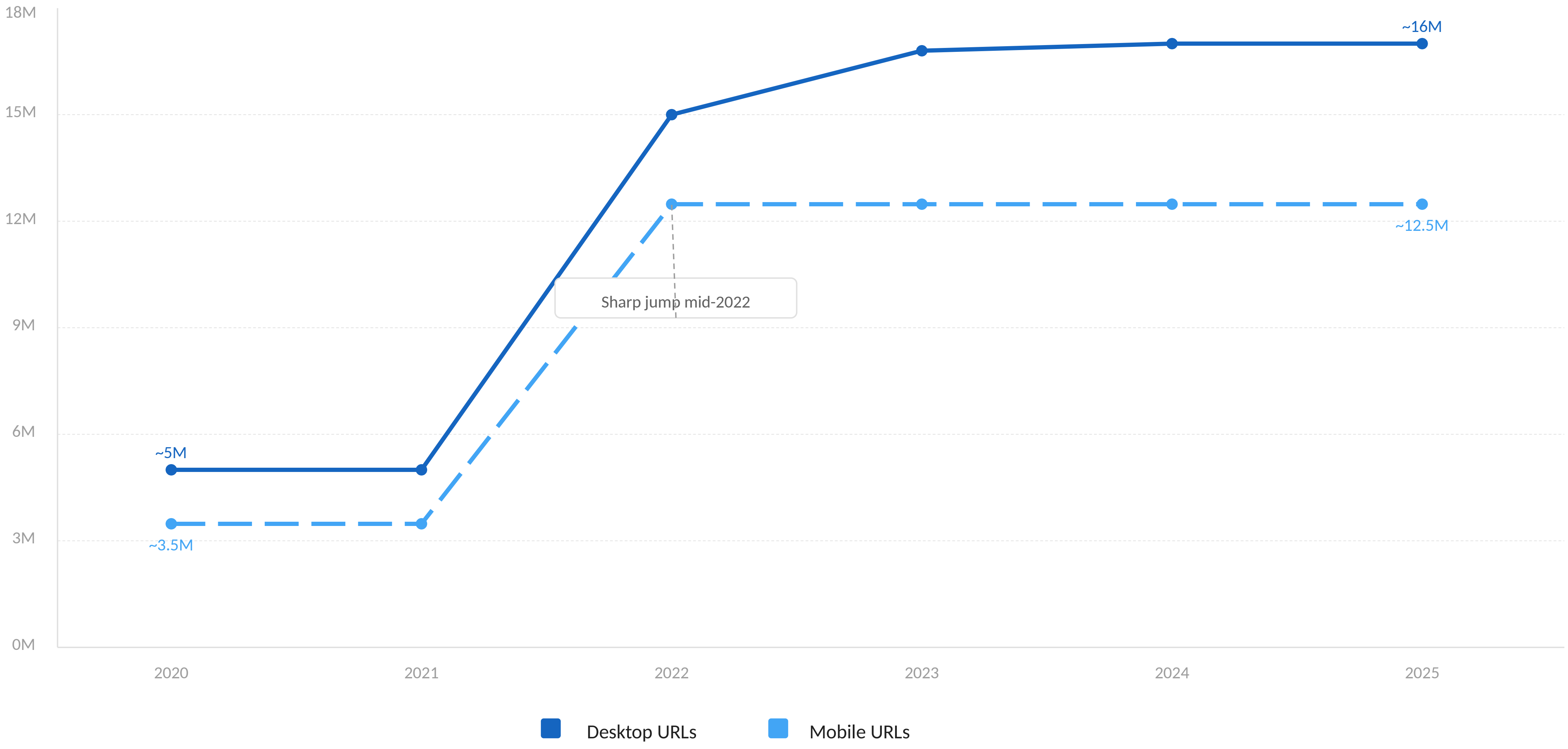
Data Source: HTTP Archive

Time Range: January 2020 – March 2026

For Web Performance Engineers & Front-End Architects

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs

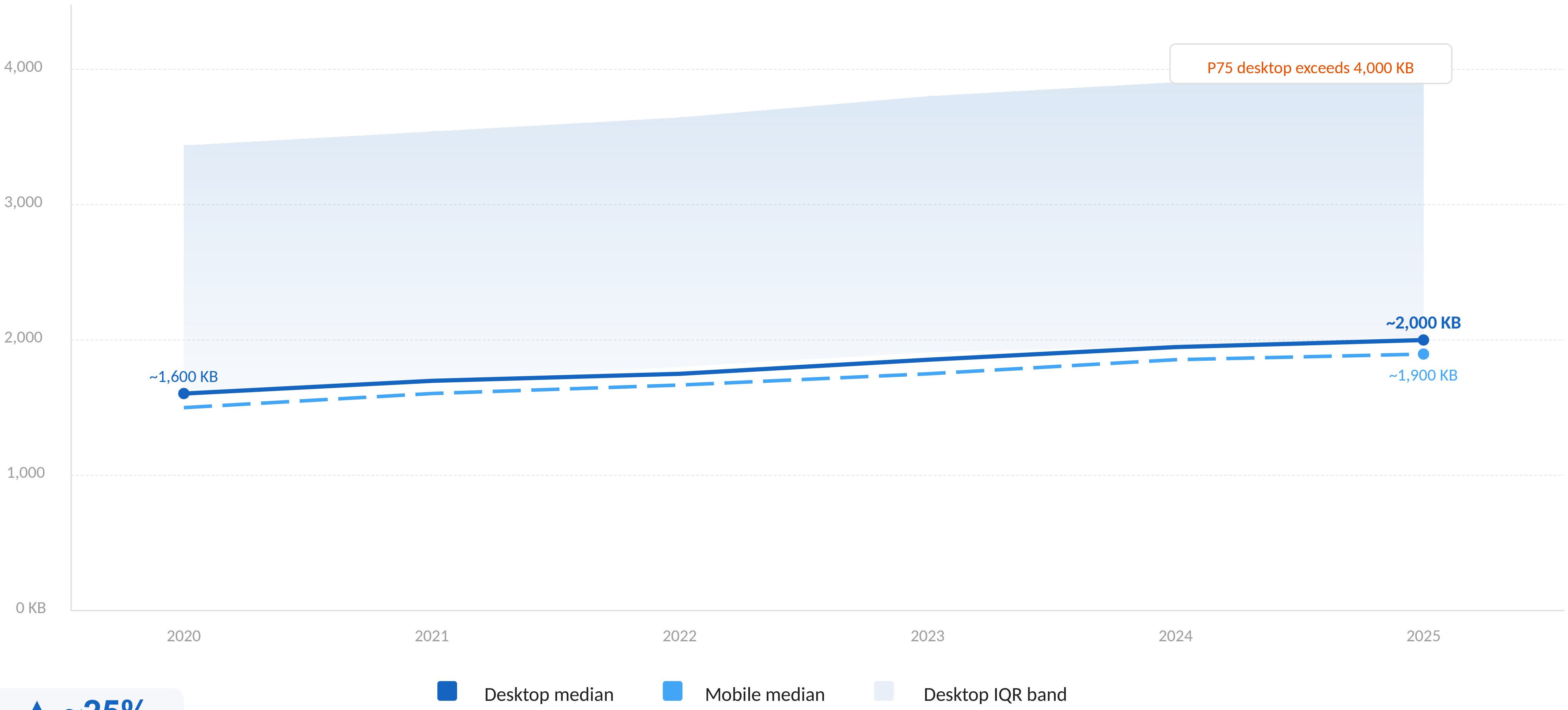
HTTP Archive's growing sample provides increasingly representative insights into how the web is built.



Source: HTTP Archive — State of the Web Report

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Pages are ~25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript payloads.



▲ ~25%
growth since 2020

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing enables more requests over fewer connections — a net efficiency gain.

Requests per Page (Median)

Desktop Requests

76 ▲ 2.7%

since 2020

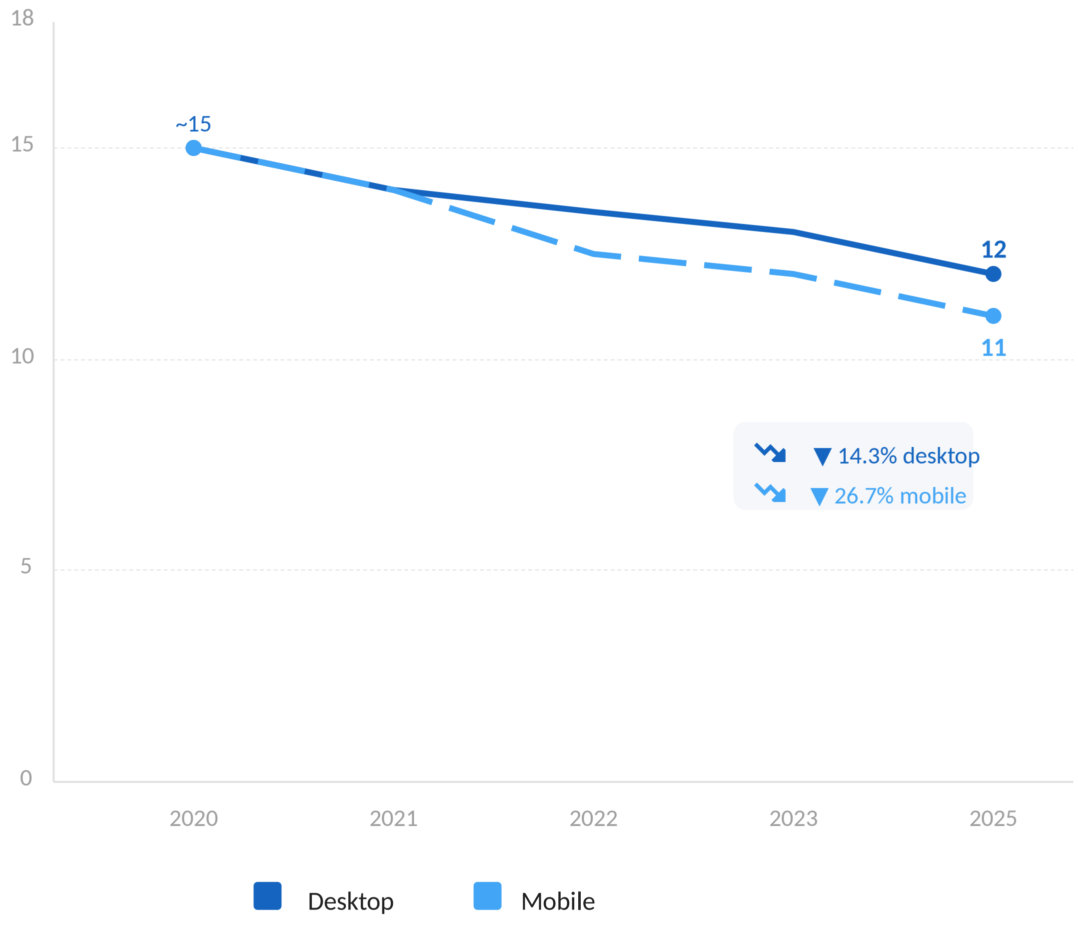
Mobile Requests

71 ▲ 2.9%

since 2020

Request counts grew modestly (~3%), while TCP connections dropped 14–27% — a clear multiplexing efficiency dividend.

TCP Connections per Page (Median)



HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web — 99%+ of requests are encrypted.

99%+

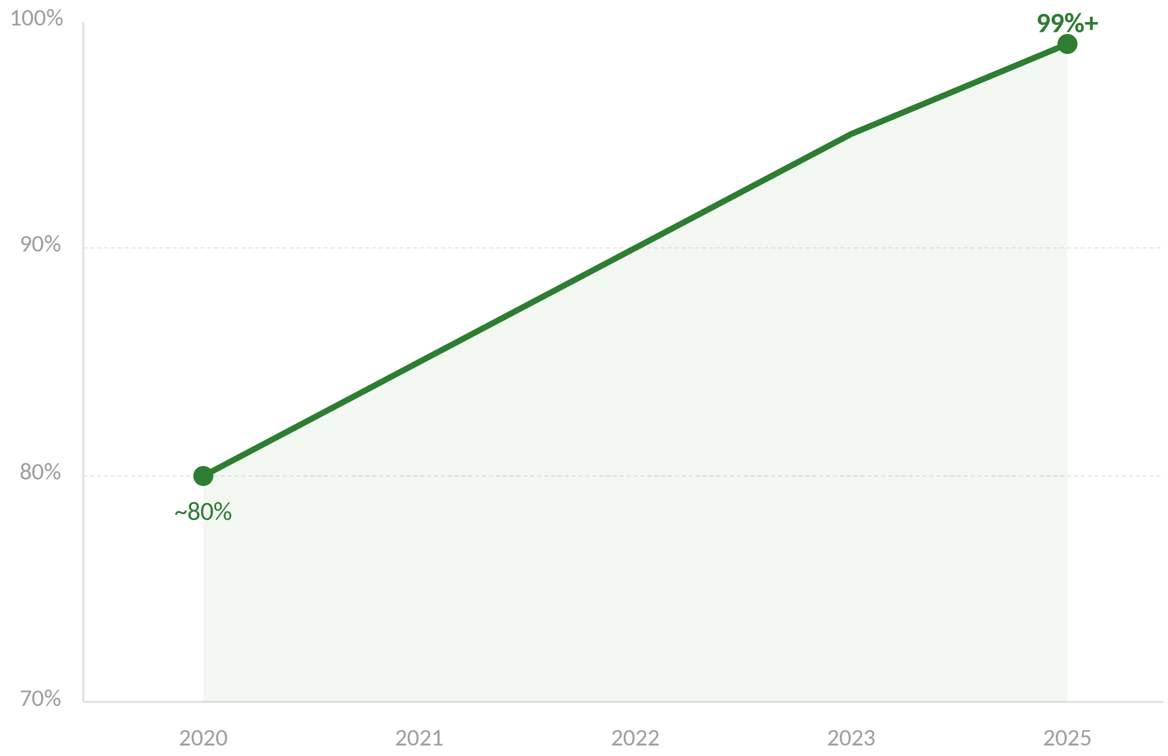
of requests use HTTPS

Desktop **99.2%**

Mobile **99.1%**

▲ ~19–20 pp since 2020

HTTPS Adoption Over Time

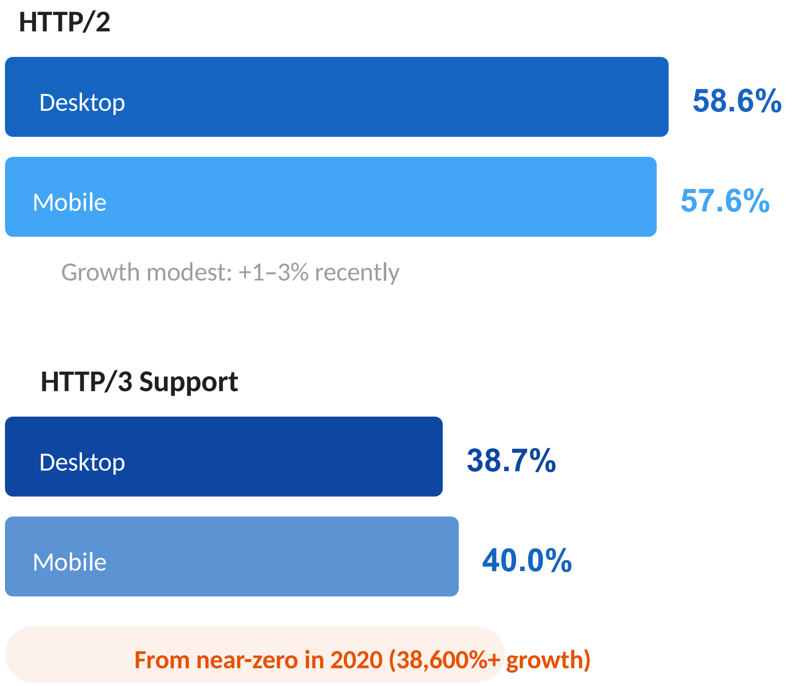


Encrypted by default

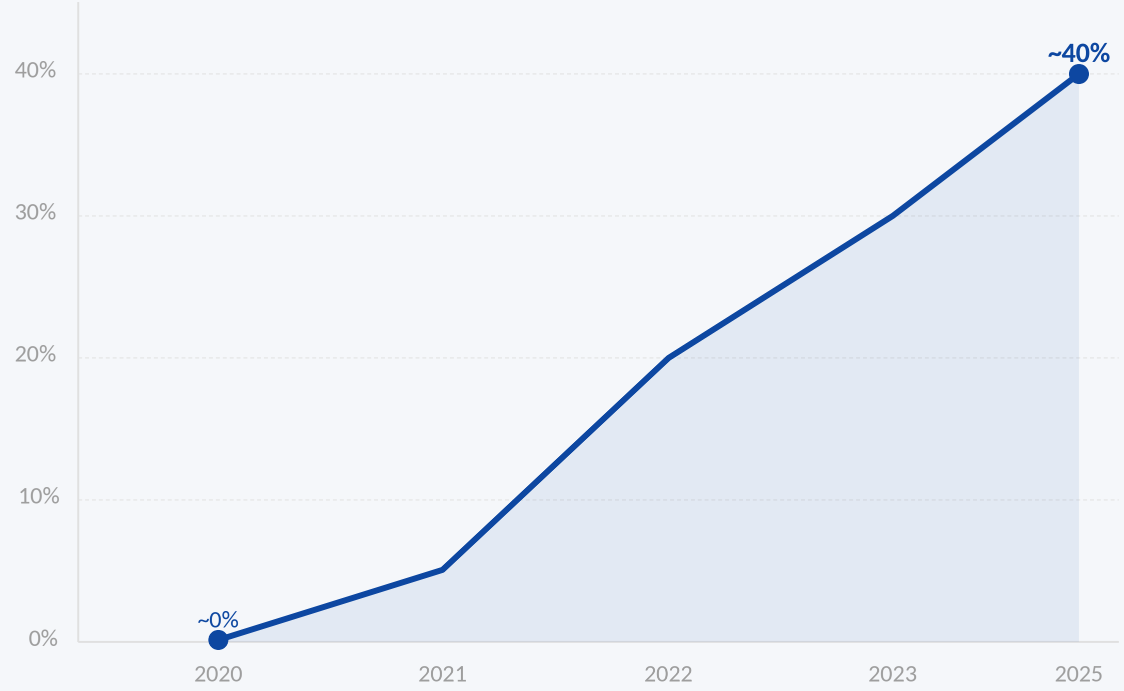
HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric — from near-zero to ~40% in under four years.

Protocol Share — Latest Snapshot



HTTP/3 Support — Rapid Rise



Note: HTTP/3 measured as support (Alt-Svc), not actual usage — fresh Chrome defaults to HTTP/2.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

More than half of pages still risk Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) during font loading.

Aa

Desktop Adoption

40.1%

▲ 14.9%

since 2020 (Lighthouse)

59.9% of pages still at risk

Aa

Mobile Adoption

42.5%

▲ 61.0%

since 2020 (Lighthouse)

57.5% of pages still at risk

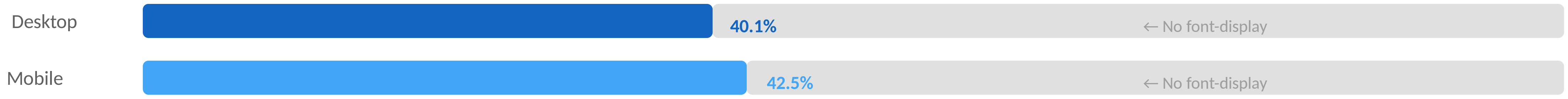
What is font-display?

A CSS property that controls how web fonts render while loading.

Without font-display:
Text is invisible until fonts load (FOIT)

With font-display: swap
Fallback font shown instantly, web font swapped in when ready

Adoption Comparison



Opportunity: More than half of pages still risk FOIT — significant room for improvement.

Source: HTTP Archive — Lighthouse audit data

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

Page Weight Keeps Climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB — roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript payloads.

HTTPS Is the New Baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web. Desktop: 99.2% | Mobile: 99.1%

HTTP/3 Is the Fastest-Growing Protocol Metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream. Desktop: 38.7% | Mobile: 40.0%

Fewer TCP Connections Despite More Requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency.

Font-Display Still Underused

At ~40–42% adoption, there is significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading.

Benchmark your sites against these baselines using HTTP Archive data at httparchive.org

Run WebPageTest, Lighthouse, or CrUX queries to see where you stand relative to global trends.